Golden Age of Science Fiction [DE2]



Second Chances
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 4201

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Golden Age of Science Fiction [DE2]

#1
08-05-2017, 08:20 PM

So lots of speculation and excitement about this era. I'm favouring Deviant, Mummy, Promethean, and Demon, but there could be lots of neat things that could be done with other lines.

Key themes off the top of my head:

- **The Oncoming Future**: While everyone loves robots and space colonies and all of that, it is worth pointing out that science fiction is also speculative fiction. A huge number of modern conveniences that we take for granted started in short stories. How does that impact creatures like Vampires, Beasts, and Mummies that can take the long view on history?
- **Utopia vs Dystopia**: Science Fiction imagines worlds that might be, revolutions increasing the standard of living for all, and forever changing the human race. At the same time, this is the era of Stalin and Hitler, and one can only imagine what would happen if these megalomanics got their hands on such power.
- **Humanity's Frailty**: Hiroshima and Nagasaki at the end of the era confirmed the darkest fears of scientists: we could destroy ourselves, completely and utterly in an instant. That is a sobering thought, and dystopian literature explored just how much damage we could do to ourselves.

If you look at Isaac Asimov specifically, all but one of the works collected in I, Robot are published in this period and the Foundation Series is well underway.

Last edited by Second Chances; 08-05-2017, 08:24 PM.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

Tags: None

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08-05-2017, 08:46 PM #2

Omegaphallic
Member

Join Date: Feb 2014
Posts: 3435

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Golden Age of Science Fiction - Wikipedia
https://en.m.wikipedia.org/wiki/Golden_Age_of_Sc…

Isn't Hubbard that Guy who founded Scientology?

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08-05-2017, 09:03 PM #3



Second Chances
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 4201

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> *Originally posted by* ***Omegaphallic***
> *https://en.m.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gold...cience_Fiction*
>
> *Isn't Hubbard that Guy who founded Scientology?*

The one who starterd a bet with the writer of Stranger In A Strange Land as to who could start a religion first? And the other guy backed out because Hubbard was too intense?

Yes he is.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | Patreon| He/His | Currently Writing: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

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08-05-2017, 11:23 PM #4



tasti man LH
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 1850

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Cross posted from the regular DE2 thread, but musing over historical events...

...while this stuff isn't *directly* related to sci-fi fiction written or conceived of at the time, it does relate to the type of thing you would find in sci-fi stories.

Within the time period there's the Battle of Los Angeles of 1942. Where in the middle of the night anti-aircraft gun emplacements in LA fired into the night at supposed enemy aircraft. Where afterwards the military brushed if off saying that the soldiers were actually firing upon was a mundane weather balloon and that it was a mistake made by some tense, overexcited airsmen. Ufologists and conspiracy theorists, however, claim that the LA military were actually engaged with extraterrestrial aircraft, and the military and government were trying to cover it up.

There's also the Roswell incident that also featured a flying object initially described as a "flying disc" and that the military later claimed that it was just a weather balloon but that Ufologists and conspiracy theorist also claim was an alien craft, but that happened in 1947, a year after the announced timeframe of this Era. So...eh.

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Omegaphallic
Member

Join Date: Feb 2014
Posts: 3435

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08-06-2017, 07:12 AM #5

> *Originally posted by* ***Second Chances***
>
> *The one who starterd a bet with the writer of Stranger In A Strange Land as to who could start a religion first? And the other guy backed out because Hubbard was too intense?*
>
> *Yes he is.*

I hope the founding of scientology is in it!

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Second Chances
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 4201

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08-06-2017, 08:25 AM #6

*Originally posted by **Omegaphallic***

I hope the founding of scientology is in it!

Likely not, that doesn't happen until 1955, but I'd be shocked if Hubbard himself wasn't meantioned.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | Patreon| He/His | Currently Writing: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

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Michael
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 3559

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08-06-2017, 08:59 AM #7

*Originally posted by **Omegaphallic***
I hope the founding of scientology is in it!

The era does include the time Hubbard spent with Aleister Crowley's OTO group in Pasadena.

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Omegaphallic
Member

Join Date: Feb 2014
Posts: 3435

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08-06-2017, 10:04 AM #8

*Originally posted by **tasti man LH***
Cross posted from the regular DE2 thread, but musing over historical events...

*...while this stuff isn't *directly* related to sci-fi fiction written or conceived of at the time, it does relate to the type of thing you would find in sci-fi stories.*

Within the time period there's the Battle of Los Angeles of 1942. Where in the middle of the night anti-aircraft gun emplacements in LA fired into the night at supposed enemy aircraft. Where afterwards the military brushed if off saying that the soldiers were actually firing upon was a mundane weather balloon and that it was a mistake made by some

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> *tense, overexcited airsmen. Ufologists and conspiracy theorists, however, claim that the LA military were actually engaged with extraterrestrial aircraft, and the military and government were trying to cover it up.*
>
> *There's also the Roswell incident that also featured a flying object initially described as a "flying disc" and that the military later claimed that it was just a weather balloon but that Ufologists and conspiracy theorist also claim was an alien craft, but that happened in 1947, a year after the announced timeframe of this Era. So...eh.*

I remember hearing about the Battle of LA in one of those UFO concpiracy shows on Netflix! Weird era.

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nofather
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 11016

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08-06-2017, 12:26 PM #9

> *Originally posted by **Second Chances***
> *Likely not, that doesn't happen until 1955, but I'd be shocked if Hubbard himself wasn't meantioned.*

Plus they tend to be perfectly fine slinging lawsuits.

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Second Chances
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 4201

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08-06-2017, 08:08 PM #10

> *Originally posted by **nofather***
>
> *Plus they tend to be perfectly fine slinging lawsuits.*

Yeah, that.

Which is a pity, because regardless of my personal thoughts about the way Scientology conducts itself (and some of its more... escentric personalities) their tenets are facinating, especially how they blend the occult with science fiction. Seeing an interpretation of them in CofD would be pretty cool.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

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nofather
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 11016

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08-06-2017, 08:15 PM #11

> *Originally posted by* ***Second Chances***
> *Which is a pity, because regardless of my personal thoughts about the way Scientology conducts itself (and some of its more... escentric personalities) their tenets are facinating, especially how they blend the occult with science fiction. Seeing an interpretation of them in CofD would be pretty cool.*

Check the Banishers book.

'In the mid-1950s, the minor pulp science fiction author Levi Bones founded a fringe religion, which he termed "Panography." His motives were a mystery. At least one source says he founded the faith on a bet; others point to the founder's unpublished writings on philosophy and religion, or his association with fringe occult groups such as Aleister Crowley's Ordo Templi Orientis. (Crowley characterized Bones as a lout and confidence man.) In any event, Bones released an amphetamine-fueled pseudoscientific history of the universe that, in conjunction with an equally dodgy book on mental health he'd written a year earlier, set down the tenets of the faith.'

It became the Militant Auditors Division.

👍 6

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atamajakki
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 5487

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08-09-2017, 11:41 PM #12

I'm a little lost on this one. Is it a pulp-y 1940s High Weirdness setting, or a look at how an emergent literary movement has impacted the world?

Remi. she/her. game designer.

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08-09-2017, 11:50 PM #13



Second Chances
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 4201

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> *Originally posted by **atamajakki***
> *I'm a little lost on this one. Is it a pulp-y 1940s High Weirdness setting, or a look at how an emergent literary movement has impacted the world?*

I'm assuming a mix that favours the latter. At least, that's the way I'd write it.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

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10-18-2017, 03:09 PM #14

So Golden Age of Science Fiction ended up being Werewolf/Deviant. I am beyond excited, especially if this means we get to learn more about extraterrestrial spirits.

Second Chances
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 4201

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Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

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10-18-2017, 04:04 PM #15

LostLight
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 4531

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> *Originally posted by **Second Chances***
> *So Golden Age of Science Fiction ended up being Werewolf/Deviant. I am beyond excited, especially if this means we get to learn more about extraterrestrial spirits.*

that immediatly makes me think about that quote from American Gods-

> *Originally posted by **Media***
> *Mass delusions are as old as I am. I was there when the Martians invaded in 1938. What a panic. Powerful panic. Now there are starmen waiting in the sky. They believed it was true, and it was*

seriously, I my brain totally missed the part that this Era starts with the World of the Worlds panic (which is one of the few Sci Fi books I read, and mostly

because that as a child I was scared to death from hearing the music record). That's going to be awesome!

Check my STV content, Or My Homebrew

"And all our knowledge is, Ourselves to know"- An Essay on Man

I now blog in here

👍 3

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English (US)

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